Ongoing Feedback / notes

MBS Transform—Replacing the Gradient
2026

MBS Transform Replacing the gradient

Link to tool from Eric: https://lissajous-brand-tool.vercel.app/

What we've heard:

1. Our brand expression needs to support the important moment our brand is in.
2. Brand and product need to feel like they come from the same hand.
3. We remain committed to one Meta blue.

Where we are:

1. We explored the Meta brand system overall and identified color as an important lever to move our brand forward.
2. After a lot of exploration, we've identified a new color palette that we think will help Meta become more recognizable and relevant.
3. We also want to explore a more adaptive approach to color long term.
4. All imagery is for proof of concept only. We are not recommending changes to art direction, typography or other elements at this time.

The ask:

We are going to deprecate the gradient What do we replace it with?

Our latest presentation to leadership on color is here

The first sprint conclusion is here

Feedback:

October 5, 2026

Link to current app

Link to last color presentation

TO DO:

Define needs: Clearly define audience and use case —

Is this for designers to create backgrounds that marketing can implement?

OR — Is there a world where non-designers can use? How do we compress the complexity we have here into a much simpler interface?

I.e. — simple — complex

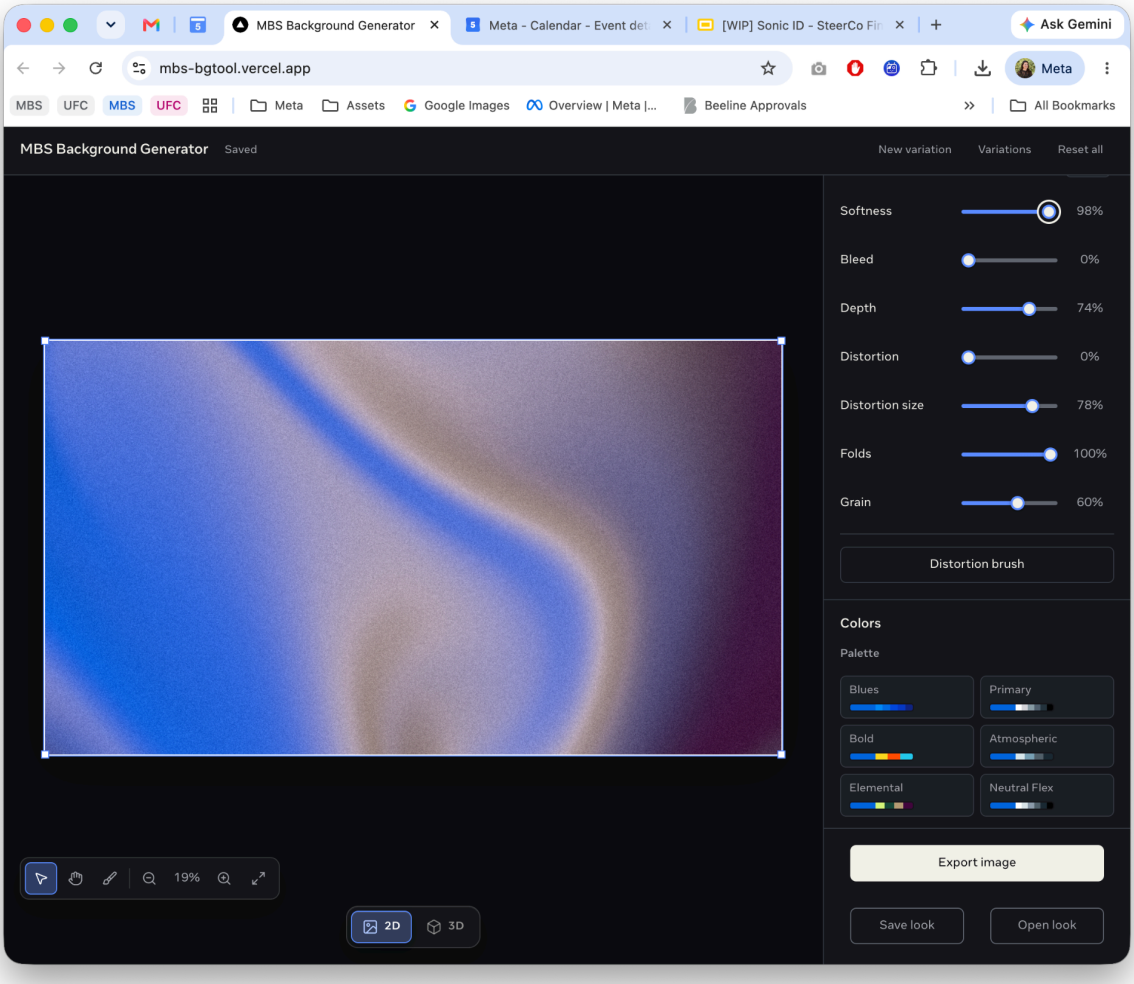
What are color combos that we would feel good about —

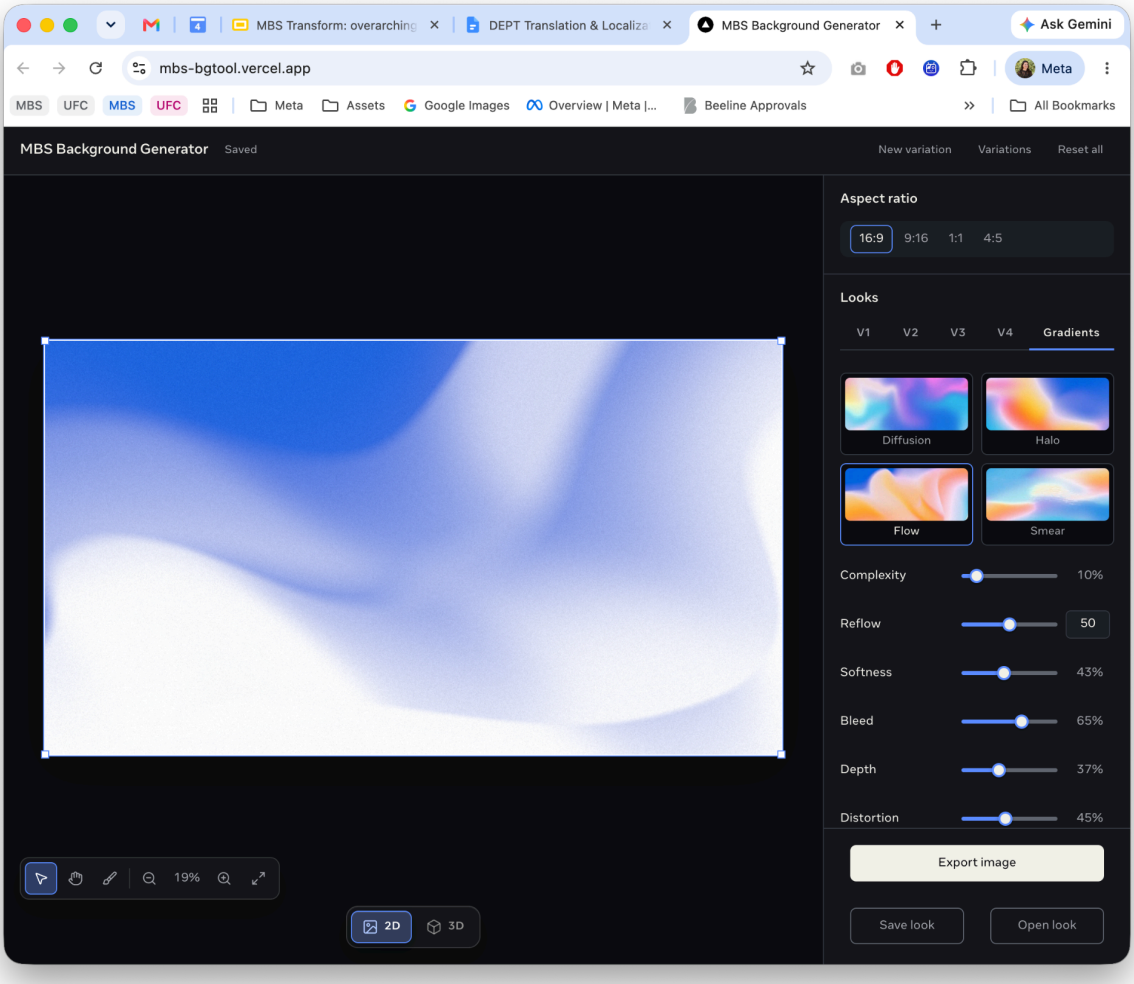
- Do we reduce options to 2-3 colors only / how can we do that without making a lot more complexity?
- Can we narrow that down?
    - Reduce down in elemental to blue - 1 other color / limit to 3 total?
    - For Bold only use blue / white - teal?
    - Break out neutrals and primary to a smaller set

Save look - when we have 5-6 looks that would be shippable we can hard code those in

Eric to think about how to simplify the rotate canvas — zoom out

- Let’s pull out one simple section to help create a tool that can create backgrounds that replace the current Meta gradient
- Do we focus on just the gradients tab for this purpose and remove V1 - V4 since they’re introducing a very new graphic language and will be hard to use as backgrounds?
- What’s the difference between Diffusion / Halo / flow and Smear?
- Diffusion and Smear feel like they’re working well Halo not so much?
- There are so many sliders to play with and interesting results as you explore each one — but feels like too many to let a non design audience go wild with — what’s a good way to gate this but still allow freedom?
- Less colors is better - do we want to bias for that?
- Overall Motion doesn’t feel like it’s working yet in this UI
- Distortion brush is very cool
- Can we change orientation of where the gradient is


MBS Background Generator
Meta - Calendar - Event det
[WIP] Sonic ID - SteerCo Fir
Ask Gemini
mbs-bgtool.vercel.app
Meta
MBS
UFC
MBS
UFC
Meta
Assets
Google Images
Overview | Meta |...
Beeline Approvals
All Bookmarks
MBS Background Generator
Saved
New variation
Variations
Reset all
Softness
98%
Bleed
0%
Depth
74%
Distortion
0%
Distortion size
78%
Folds
100%
Grain
60%
Distortion brush
Colors
Palette
Blues
Primary
Bold
Atmospheric
Elemental
Neutral Flex
19%
2D
3D
Export image
Save look
Open look



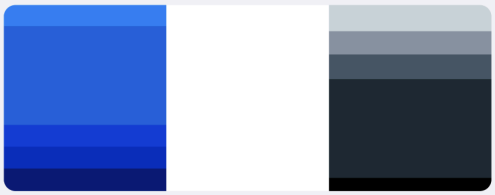
September 1, 2026

Current color palettes for the testing in the tool:

Where we want to go

We need the Meta brand to be recognizable and relevant in its own right. Refocusing from gradients to distinct swatches, builds stronger brand equity and unlocks more expressive storytelling.

PRIMARY COLOR

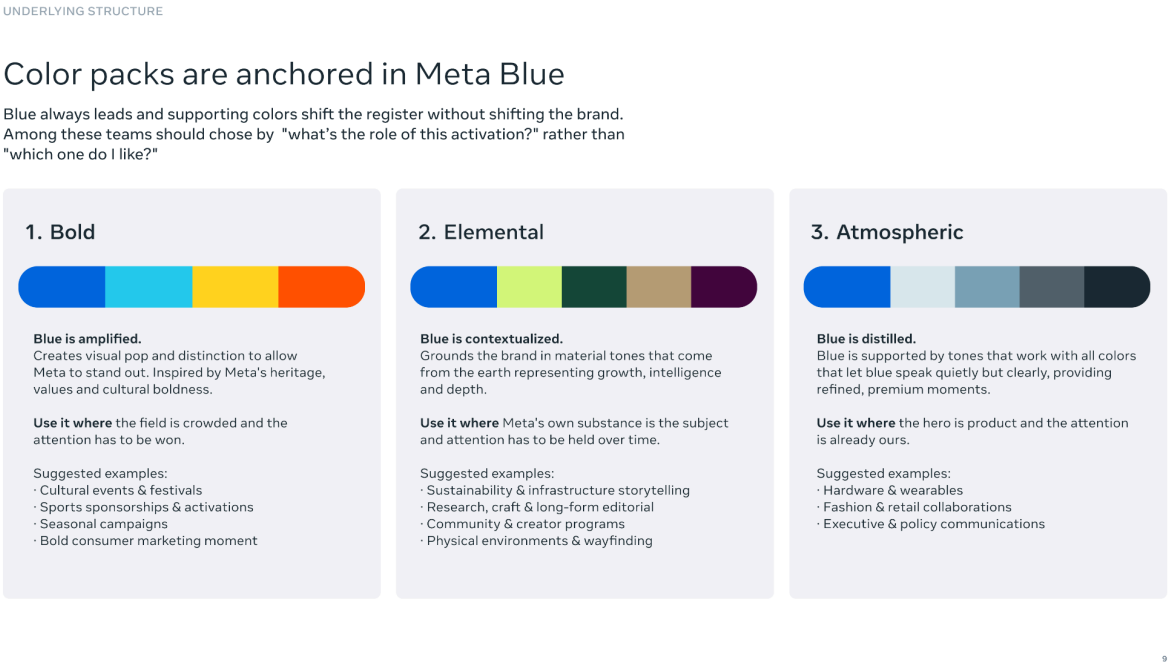


COLOR PACKS

Bold

Elemental

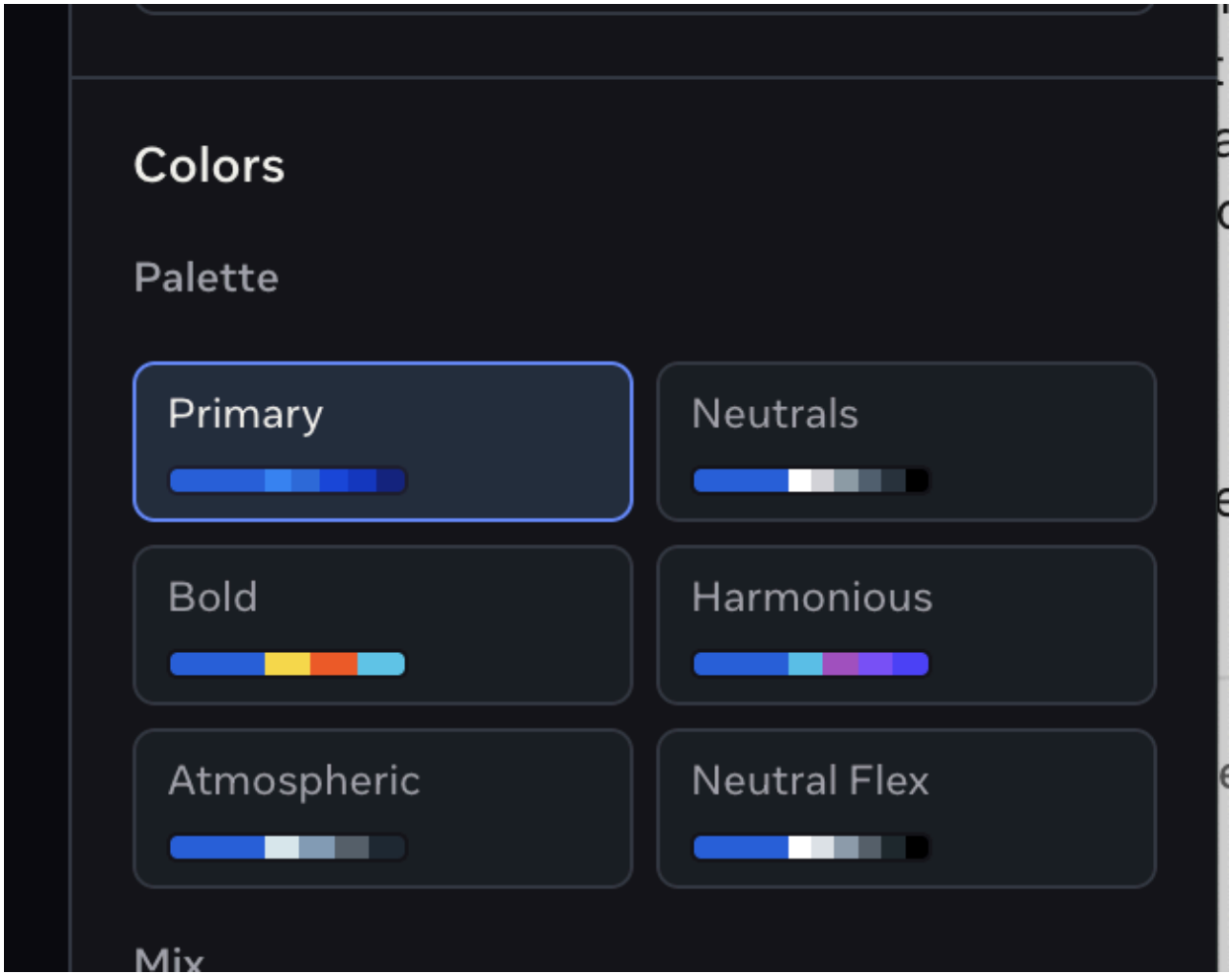
Atmospheric



Figma with values are here:
https://www.figma.com/proto/lwbxBZlSZZ9EUmN86JpyPe/Color-Presentations-%7C-MBS-Transform?node-id=3159-23564&viewport=159%2C11%2C0.07&t=6ifGd7TsXWUlH0OR-1&scaling=min-zoom&content-scaling=fixed&page-id=3159%3A21488

Harmonious is being ditched because the Meta AI colors are going away.

Maybe the word primary here goes to Blues only — then Neutrals is Primary / core
Then Bold, atmospheric and we have this new one Elemental.



Feedback:

Current color palettes for the testing in the tool:

Bold

Creates visual pop and distinction to allow Meta to stand out. Inspired by Meta's heritage, values and cultural boldness.

Suggested examples:

- Cultural events & festivals
- Sports sponsorships & activations
- Seasonal campaigns
- Bold consumer marketing moments

Meta blue: #0064E0

Yellow: #FFD61E

Orange: #FF4F00

Teal: #25C8EE

Harmonious

Enables fluid gradients and seamless transitions as an evolution of the current color system.

Suggested examples:

- Technology innovation narratives
- Business agents & tools
- Platform ecosystem storytelling

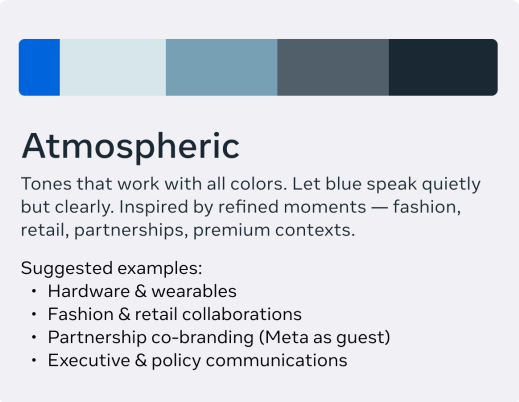
Meta blue: #0064E0

Light blue: #1AC5ED

Pink-purple: #AF4EC5

Lilac: #814DFF

Purple: #5043FF



Meta blue: #0064E0

Light blue-gray: #D7E7EE

Medium blue-gray: #7CA0B7

Meta gray 700: #53606A

Meta gray: #1C2B33

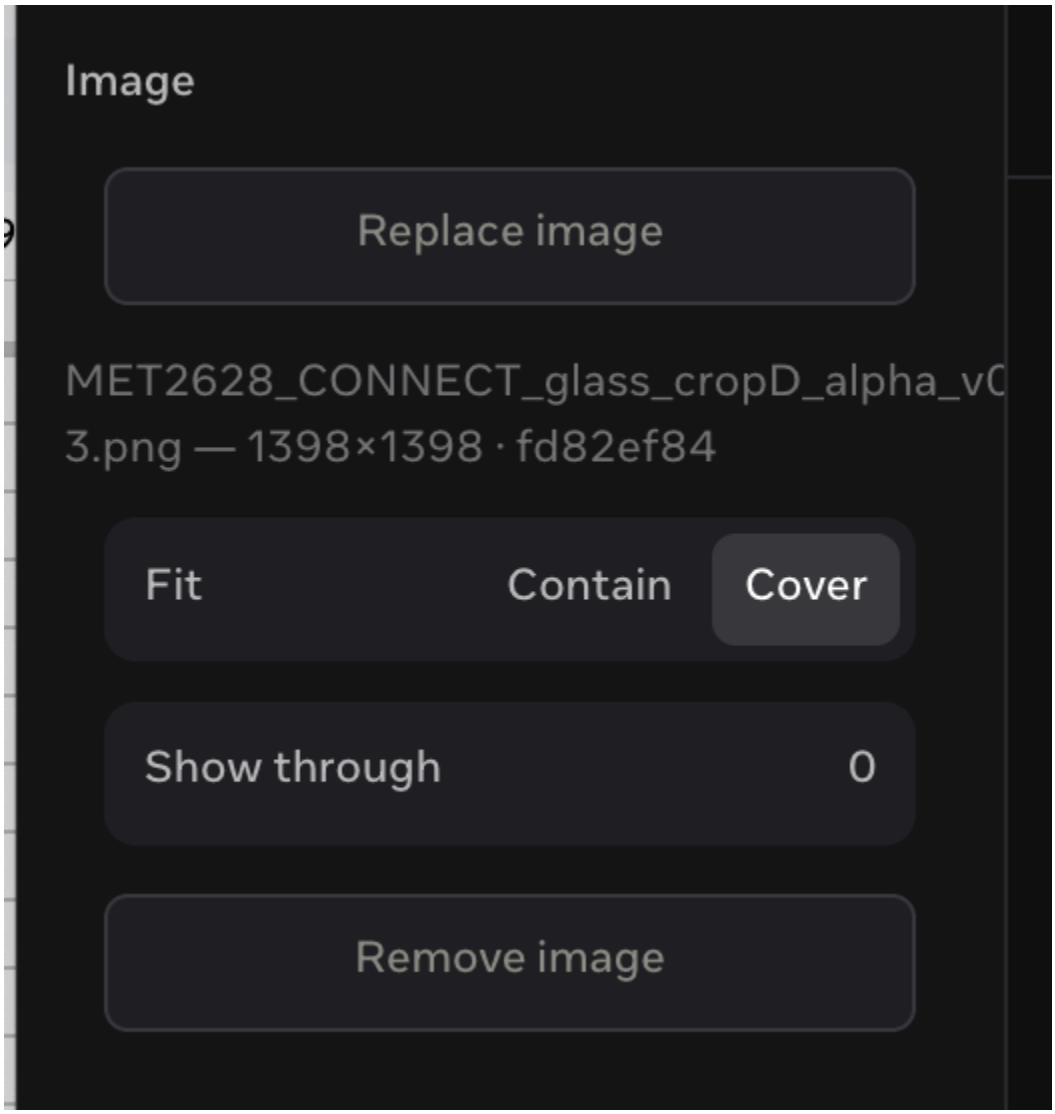
Background generation tool leveraging MBS primary and (in dev) adaptive color packs:

We'd love to take some of the great thinking and parameters already established in the current tool prototype and focus it around being able to generate backgrounds which utilize Meta's color palette. This could be a great way of replacing the gradient, while adding even more expression to the MBS.

Can we separate the LAB section from the other parts — we want to truly reduce the tool to a very simple app generation tool so dial it down quite a bit by removing say 80% of it (well keeping for further discovery for this system down the road) but for this task and to make something we can work with and ship let's strip it back.
Remove / separate LAB from design and motion

Remove:

Since this is about building backgrounds - we can remove this section from the left side:



Parameters we want:

Canvas size and scale:

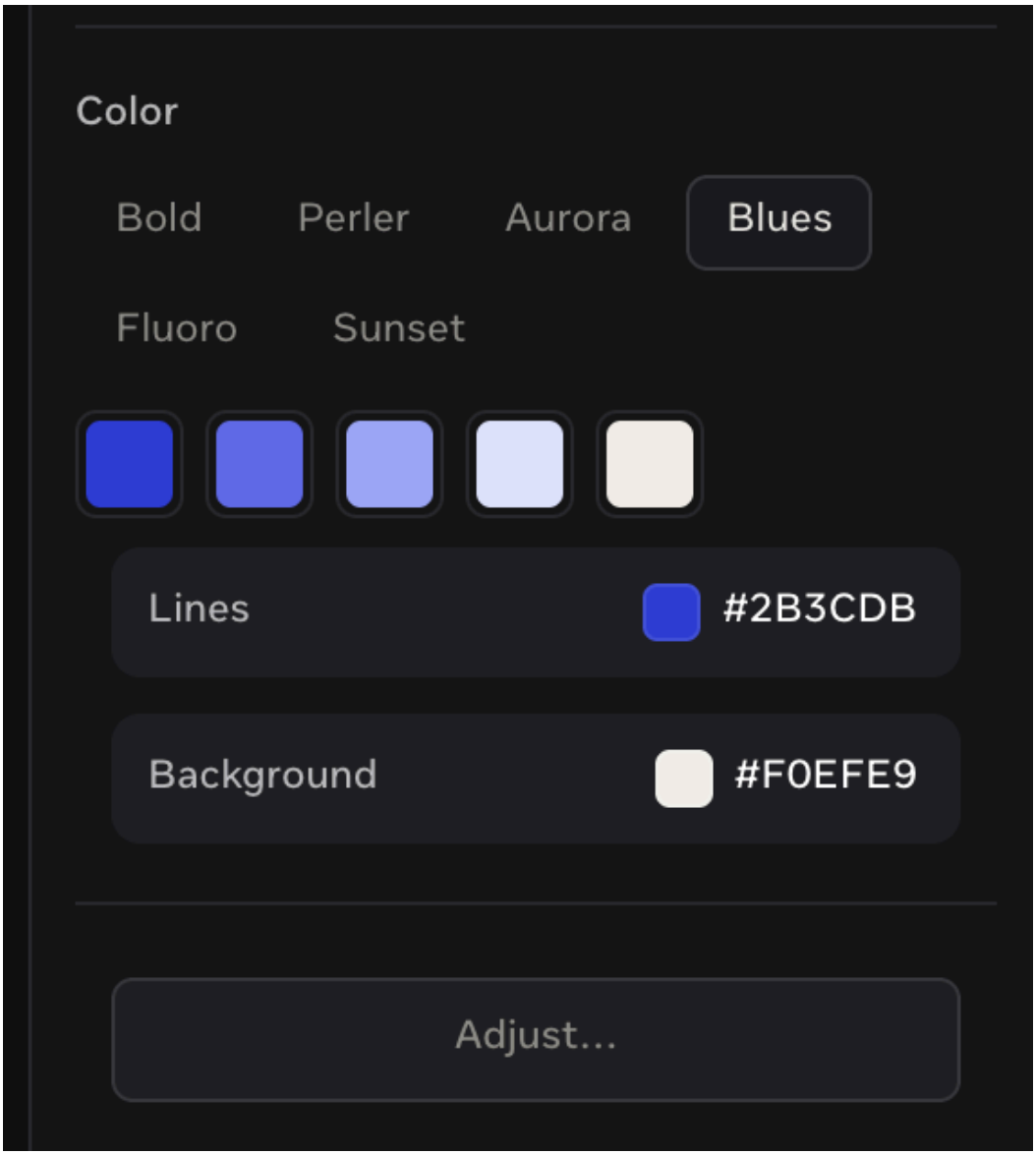
- The option to select between different aspect ratios:
    - 16:9
    - 9:16
    - 1:1

    - 4:5
- Resolutions up to 4K (possibly 8K if it's doable within a reasonable file export size and render burden on the tool)
- Flexibility to be able to zoom in and crop at different points of the canvas, without losing resolution: free form crops and fixed crops at the aspect ratios above would be ideal

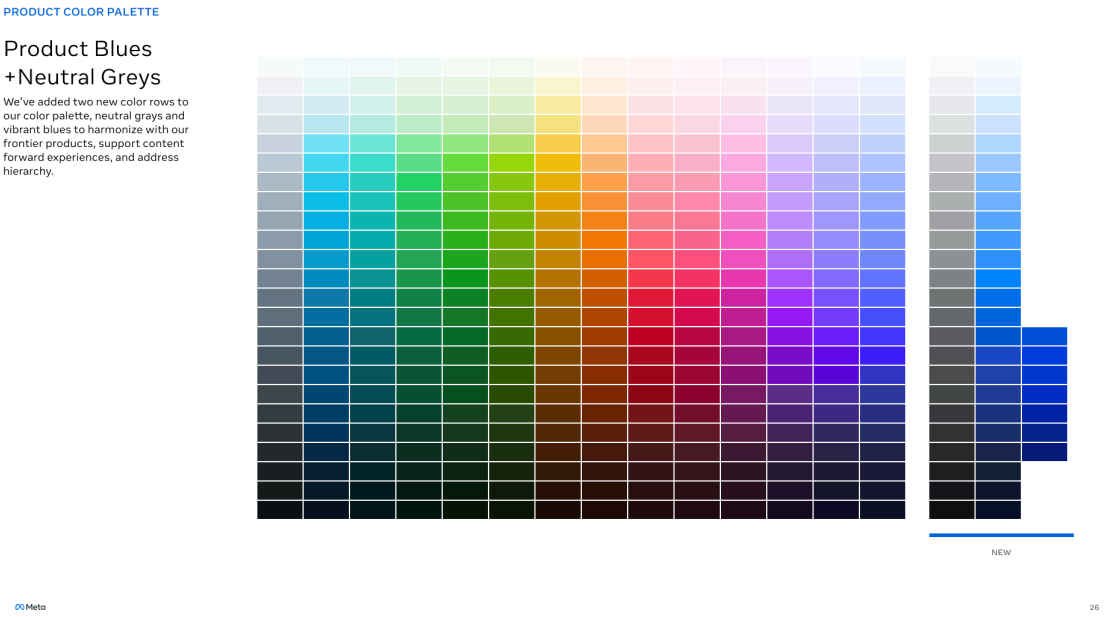
Color selection and flexible ratios:

- MBS primary palette should be built into the tool
- MBS secondary color packs should also be integrated - thinking here:

- These subsets could be bold, harmonious, atmospheric and neutrals (links are to each moodboard with swatches)



- We have a specific extended palette as well - can we limit to these specifically vs. allowing for any input or hex value. What is the best way to get you these values? They are in a figma library and / or available as tokens.

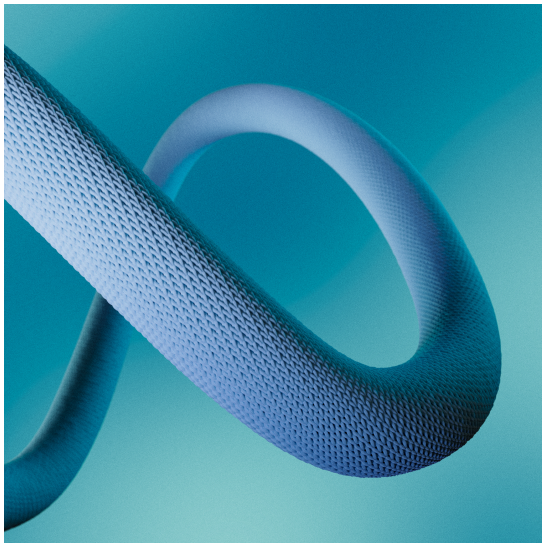


- Would be ideal to have labeling that distinguishes between the 2 tiers (primary/secondary)
- Build in for each a color blending and a slider tool (with freeform inputs) that can customize color ratios: ex. the ability for 90% of the canvas to be Meta blue and 10% of the canvas to be secondary colors, and so on. A composition can be forced to lean towards certain colors, some may be removed completely.

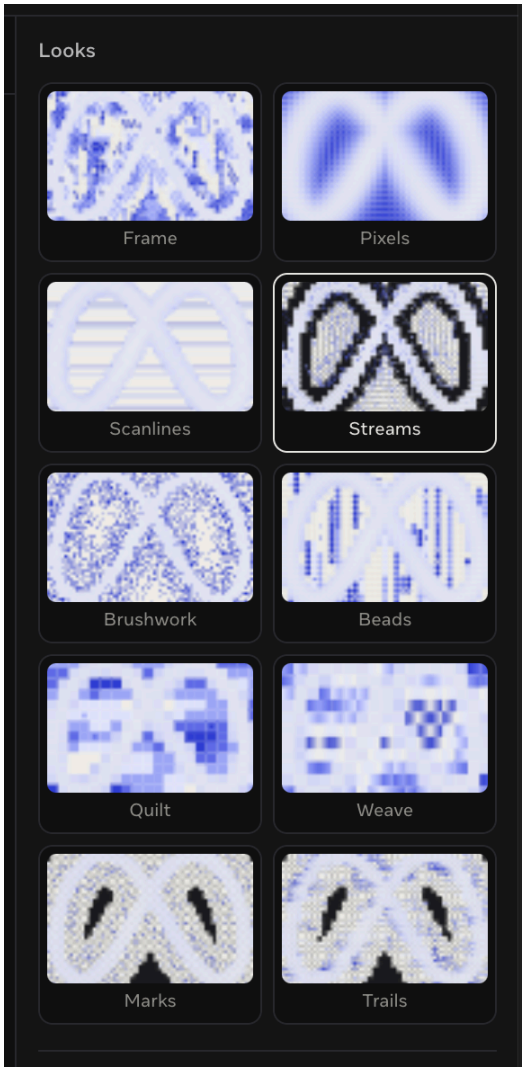
Materiality and dimension:

- The option to apply different pre-determined materials to the colors on the canvas: this could be something that starts small with a few options and extends in the future: examples of materials could include:
    - Liquid (with bubbles)
    - Glass
    - Metal
    - Film grain
    - Pixelation
    - CRT scan lines with phosphor glow
- The option to add light sources and z-space (with blurring) to create a sense of dimension and 3D space

Shape and pattern:

- In addition to the logo at full view,
-
- we'd like to be able to crop in on the meta logo as a primary shape driving the different "looks"
- Again these would be inspiring shapes and patterns that would be used as backgrounds for marketing, communications and layered on top with type and imagery. We don't need to do the layering here we already have workflows for that — so just the backgrounds
- Some examples of crops:
- 

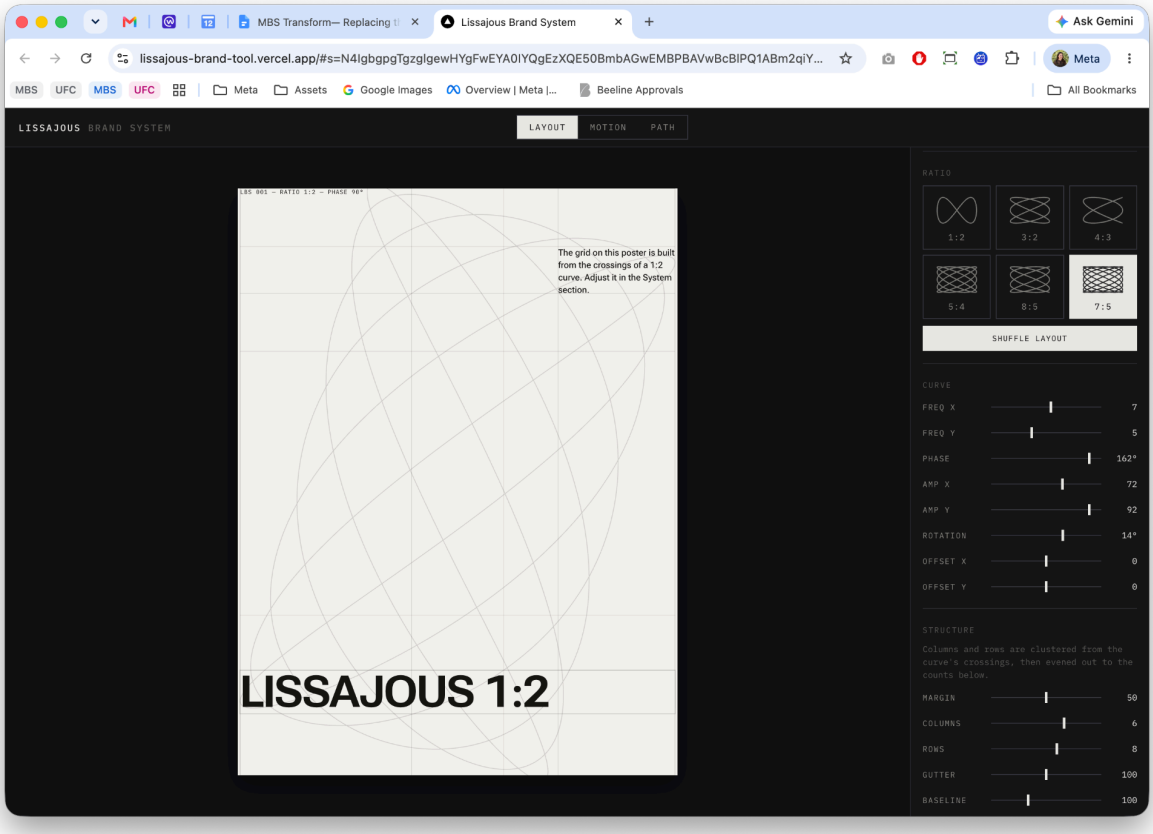
These are all cool and I think we should keep them:



Moonshots:

- The ability to add motion to backgrounds, static is great for now as the tool develops.

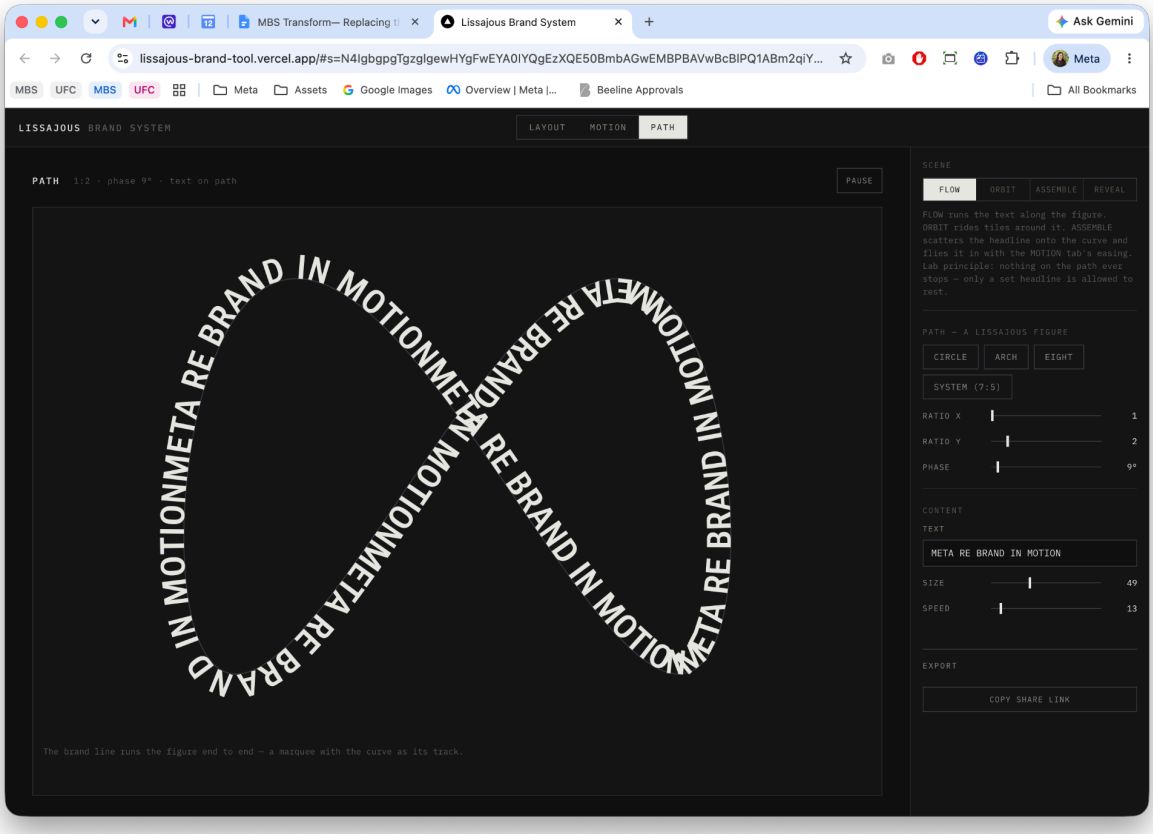
Layout



I love this so much , the grids feel organized but fresh. I think we'd want to understand what would be the finite number of options we'd want to equip teams with so users / customers would find it an identifiable system that drives attribution for them.

We also do have an existing grid system and no need to change it at this moment, I think this is also useful to show as we continue to explore, but mostly we can back pocket this until that extension of the brand comes up for refresh.

Path



I love this also - I think this is an immediately useful tool. I think it would make sense to have a preset at just the right degree for the Meta logo (in addition to the flexibility you also have - it never quite gets there could we adjust it so that it does?) I also want to crop it, but I guess that could happen outside of this tool.

Motion:

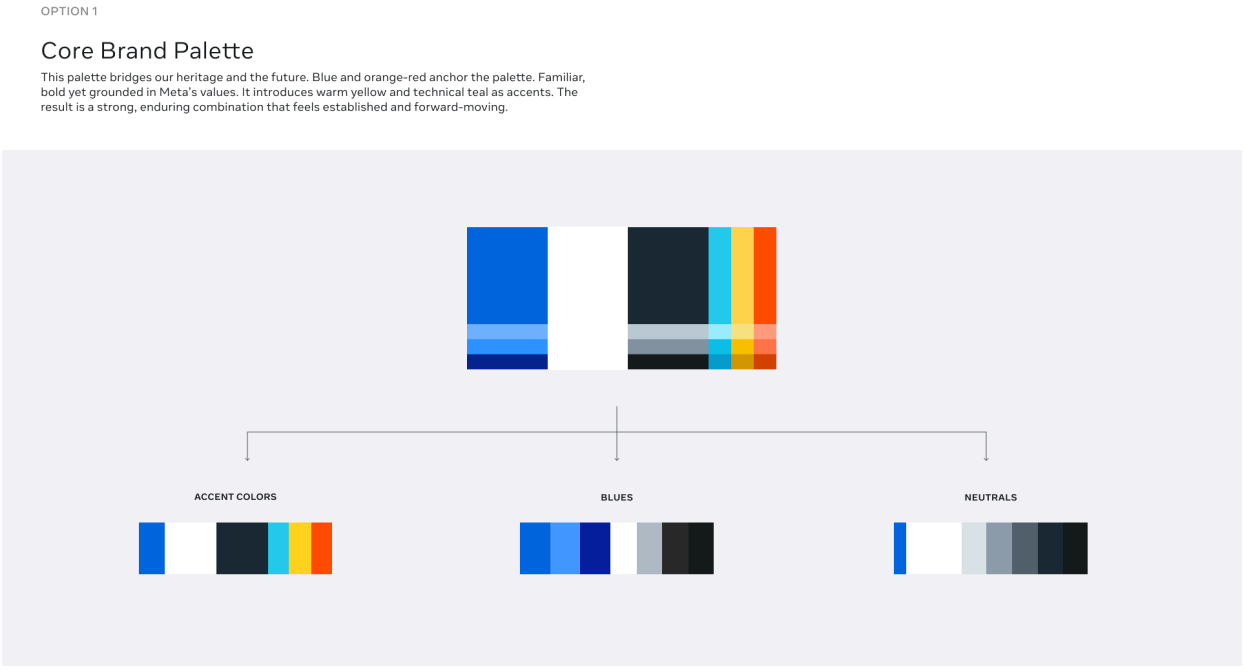
I'll skip this one for now.

Color:

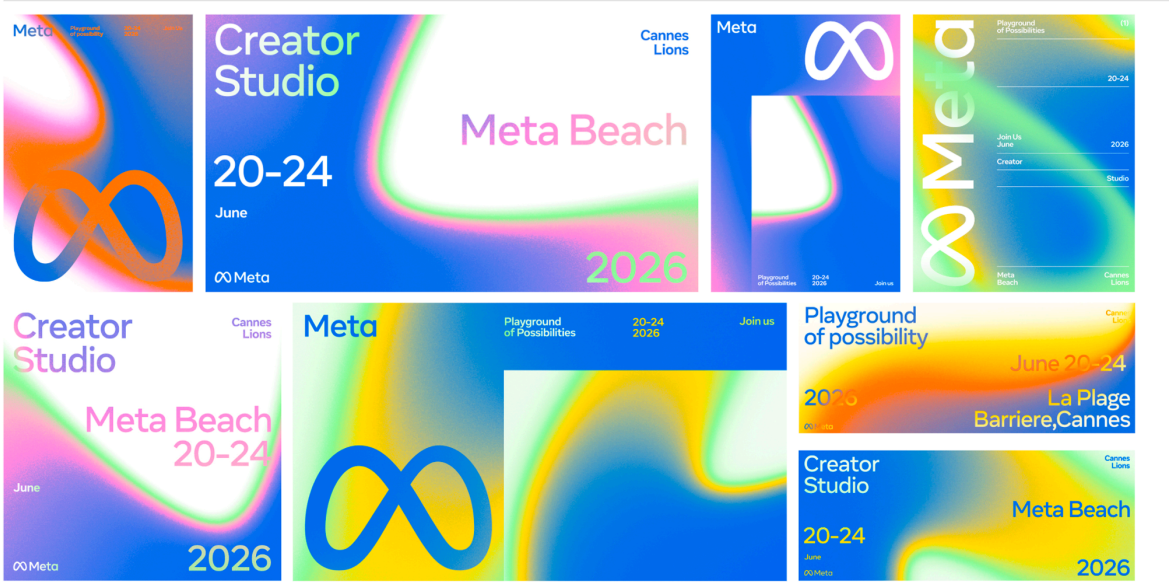
[Links to assets]

Where I think it would be great to focus — We have a green light to begin testing our proposed accent color palette and I'd love to layer in color to this tool to see if we can use it to create preset expressions for teams to use. On the first page with the layout you have placeholder background images and the option to upload images, but that is probably where we'd stick the gradient in today's system and that is our most pressing asset to replace. How might we focus there?

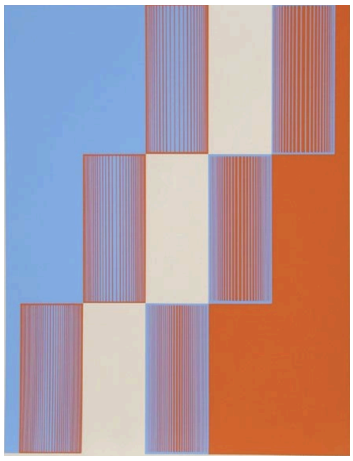
We have this set of 3 colors and their tints as well as the opportunity to lean into blues or neutrals.

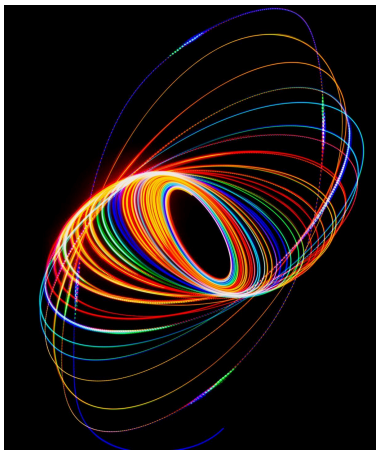
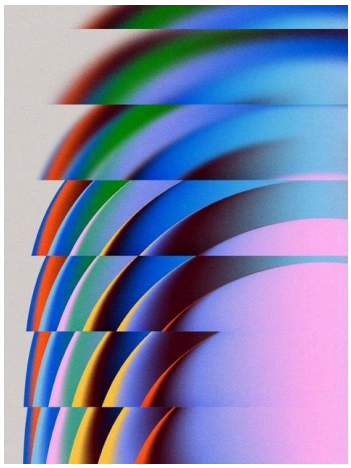
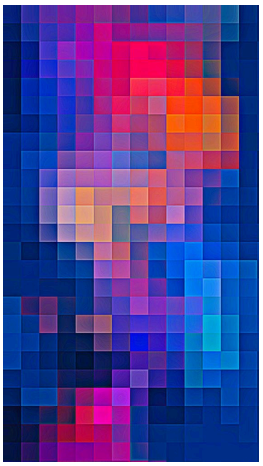


Curious how we might think about using the symbol to create patterns or abstract backgrounds that would allow for flexibility with these colors? Here's an example from a recent Cannes experience that i think does this well.



It could be gradients — but it could also be blocks of color. Ultimately we want teams to be able to export assets to use as backgrounds behind type layouts, layouts with photography or ads etc.



from toga

Okay, I recorded a brain-dump and had AI organize my thoughts:

Gradient Tool: Feedback

First impression

- The landing view is overwhelming. Too many settings and sliders at once, and no clear starting point.
- “Composite” being the default texture, with full color is very intimidating.
- Labels could be more descriptive.
- Group secondary controls into dropdowns or collapsible show/hide sections so the default view is simpler.

Landing moment

- The first thing people should see is a simple, interactive version of the logo. It immediately signals "this is a tool for backgrounds and brand assets."
- Surface a row of presets (made by us or by users) along the bottom so nobody starts from a blank state.

Visual design

- The UI currently has a generic, default look. Fine for now, but we'll want to bring it on brand over time.
- Adopt our current language where possible, for example "Color Packs."

Color controls

- Default color selection to Meta colors and our Color Packs.
- Custom palettes should still be possible, but less prominent. Push that option a few clicks deeper so the on-brand path is the easy one.

Modes and labeling

- The 2D / 3D toggle needs to be more prominent. Reconsider the labels themselves. "Logo / Texture" or "2D Texture / 3D Logo" would be clearer about what each mode produces.
- Decide on a default mode. 3D feels like the stronger first impression.

Background options

- Slight rethink of the backgrounds. Concept around distinct vibes or tones so the choices feel intentional and cover a tonal range. Could textures come from some aspect of the brand.
- Consider these will be updated every so often.

Typography

- No text or type layout support right now.
- A typography layout mode would put people in a familiar layout-building space on landing and clarify how type works alongside the logo.

Open question

- Who is the primary user? Every brand, sub-brand, and technology has its own system. Defining the use cases would help us prioritize.

Upload your own assets

- Let people bring in their own logo or assets to modify.
- Could we use an AI 3D-generation model so a flat logo upload becomes an editable 3D version inside the tool?

What-ifs

These are bigger than tweaks and may mean rethinking the structure:

Progress-led flow

- Step the experience out: 1) pick your color, 2) pick your pattern, 3) edit the pattern, and so on.
- Each step shows only the relevant controls, which solves much of the overwhelm.
- In the end, users can go enter a

All options visible (MS Paint style)

- Lay every option out visibly, with dropdowns that expand to show the full range at a glance.
- See the whole toolkit, pick, and go.